II

PART TWO · ✦

House Aurem

A townhouse on Covenant Row, four professionals who've done this before, and the minister back home who wouldn't sign.

i · The House and the people in it	116
Hannah	119
Naomi	136
Mirielle	148
Gavin	153
Abigail	158
Senior Minister Bell	164
The Aurem officials	171
Working questions for House Aurem	173

TL | CR | FR 26–34

THE HOUSE'S YEAR

One Covenant Daughter. Aurem has produced fifteen Anointed Wives in thirty-eight Trials, more than any other Dominion, so an Aurem House is expected to win (DOM).

MARGINALIA

The House and the people in it

House Aurem is one of twelve townhouses on Covenant Row, five minutes' walk from Sovereign Boulevard, wired in every common area and garden and left unwatched in the bedrooms (CR). A House hosts one Covenant Daughter per Trial, and its staff serve across many (FR 26). Eden's are the House Mother, the House Coordinator, the stylist and the Debate and Protocol Advisor (TL).

They're professionals, and each has watched girls lose. Hannah has done six Trials and has twelve girls across her career, none of them hers (TL, FR 26). Gavin has dressed girls who were smarter and richer and better placed than Eden (TL). Abigail reads candidates for a living (TL). What they want from Eden is mostly what the Empire wants from her, until it isn't, and the dossiers track where each one's loyalty actually sits. Senior Minister Bell is the odd one out. He's in Aurelia, not the Crownward, and his part of the story is over before Eden boards the train. He's here because Eden carries what he did with her into every room the House puts her in (DR3).

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, arrival and the Covenant Houses, 567.

House Aurem, drawn

TKC: CR · TR · TL

VOL. I · 567 · 499

WHERE IT IS	Covenant Row, parallel to Sovereign Boulevard on the Sovereign Side, under five minutes' walk from the Boulevard (**CR**).
WHAT'S WATCHED	Every common area, entrance and garden. The bedrooms aren't, by calculation and not decency, because unwatched bedrooms keep candidates manageable (**CR**).
WHO KNOWS THE GAPS	Hannah knows the back staircases and the camera gaps, and always has (**TL**).

HOUSE AUREM · FLOOR PLAN · MARK THE CAMERAS, THE BACK STAIRS AND THE ONE PLACE THEY AREN'T

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE ROOM IN THE HOUSE WHERE EACH OF THE FOUR STAFF GOES TO BE ALONE



PORTRAIT · HANNAH · HOUSE MOTHER OF HOUSE AUREM

TKC: TL · FR 26–34

VOL. I · 393 · 561 · 567

PART II · DOSSIER 8 · ✦

HANNAH

*Six Trials. Twelve girls. None of them hers (**TL**). She doesn't let herself feel what she can't act on, so she's built a very precise system for acting on everything that matters.*

ON THE RECORD

House Mother of House Aurem. Formerly Vowed (**FR 30**). Twelve girls across her career, six through Aurem Trials and six through earlier posts (**FR 26**). Her daughter Naomi has one year left in Vowed education (**TL**). Knows the back staircases and the camera gaps (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

Her surname, her age, what Judah has "always known" about her (**TL**), and the year she's never said out loud (**FR 30**).

TKC: TL · FR 26 · FR 30–32 · FR 34

VOL. I · 501 · 529

The Registry card

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

COVENANT ROW · SOVEREIGN SIDE · CROWNWARD

NAME OF RECORD	*HANNAH*_____
POST	*House Mother · six Aurem Trials (**TL**)*
CAREER	*twelve Covenant Daughters, several Houses and posts (**FR 26**)*
FORMER DESIGNATION	*Vowed (**FR 30**)*
HOUSEHOLD	*her own · daughter Naomi eligible through it (**FR 31–32**)*
NAOMI'S FATHER	*elite ladder, below Crown level · living · not in the household (**FR 31**)*
2085	_____

HOUSE MOTHER

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
HANNAH	The House, the girls	
HOUSE MOTHER	The Commission, the Broadcast	
MOTHER	Naomi	

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER SURNAME, AND WHY NOBODY IN THE FILES USES IT

TKC: TL · FR 26 · FR 30–31 · FR 34 · FR 39

VOL. I · 561

Her years against the Empire's

YEAR	HER LIFE	SOURCE
c. 2060–67	Born. **INFERENCE** A Covenant Daughter in 2085 was between eighteen and twenty-five.	
2085	**INFERENCE** One of the twelve in the cancelled cohort. Assembled, prepared, measured against the others, then sent home with her designation intact and no placement.	FR 34, Vol. I, 561
	Vowed	FR 30
	A Binding on the elite ladder, below Crown level. Naomi born.	FR 31
	Naomi's father leaves the household. Why stays open.	FR 31
	Six earlier assignments, six girls	FR 26
	Six Aurem Trials, six girls	TL, FR 26
2104	The 39th. Eden. Naomi has a year left in Vowed education.	TL

OPEN QUESTION In what order did the 2085 cohort, the Vowed years and the Binding come? A woman leaves Vowed service through marriage (Vol. I, 501).

THE YEAR SHE'S NEVER SAID OUT LOUD, AS SHE'D TELL IT IF SHE EVER DID

The clerk's version and the true one

TKC: TL · TR · CR · FR 26–29

VOL. I · 567 · 573

ON THE LEDGER	House Mother. She travels to the Crownward with her Covenant Daughter and two Appointed Officers (**TR**), and she's staff across many Trials, never the House's owner (**FR 26**).
IN FACT	She knows the back staircases and the camera gaps, and always has (**TL**). She doesn't let herself feel things she can't act on, and has built a precise system for acting on everything that matters (**TL**).
WHAT A CAREER COSTS	FR 26 makes her twelve a career count, which "ages her in the work." Every one of the twelve was married down the ladder or went to the heir (**FR 19, 25**).
WHAT SHE CAN DO FOR NAOMI	Hannah can submit Naomi's name, and she isn't the only one who can. Naomi can self-nominate once she's eligible, the way Eden did. Hannah's power is influence and not legal control (**FR 27**).
WHAT DECIDES IT	If Eden wins, Hannah enters Naomi, because winning proves the ladder can be climbed. If Eden dies or is publicly rejected, Hannah gets her out, and the only exit is a designation lower than the Trials reach (**FR 29**).

WHAT HAPPENED TO EACH OF HER TWELVE GIRLS. NAME THE ONES YOU CAN.

TKC: TL · FR 30 · CR

VOL. I · 501 · 509 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	The Temple, as a Vowed woman (**FR 30**). The Crownward's Vowed are trained to perform devotion under close observation, and to hold what they know in memory instead of on paper (**CR**).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**INFERENCE** Act on everything that matters, and feel nothing you can't act on (**TL**). **OPEN QUESTION** Whether she believes in God, the Temple, or only in the system she's built.
WHAT SHE CAN RECITE	**INFERENCE** Everything a Vowed woman is formed in, and everything a House Mother says on camera.
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	**INFERENCE** What she knows about the camera gaps, and whatever she does with them.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

A House Mother serves the House, and the House "always judges fairly" (**DR3**). **POSSIBLE** The Temple preaches 1 Samuel 1.28, "I have lent him to the LORD," at every House Mother's commissioning, so handing over a girl who isn't hers becomes the highest kind of motherhood. It never preaches what Hannah does with her own.

WHAT SHE PRAYS, IF SHE PRAYS, THE NIGHT BEFORE A DECLARATION

The text

1 SAM 1–2

1 SAM 1.15

1 SAM 1.28

1 SAM 2.4–8

ESTH 2.8–9, 15

JER 38.7–13

HER NAME	Hannah, the mother of Samuel, who prays at Shiloh with no sound and is taken for drunk, vows her son to the sanctuary, and brings him a little robe every year. Her song is the model for Mary's (Vol. I, 393).
WHERE IT BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** The story runs in reverse. Biblical Hannah gives the son she prayed for. This Hannah gives other women's daughters every year and is deciding whether to give her own (FR 29, Vol. I, 393).
HEGAI · ESTHER 2	**POSSIBLE** The keeper of the women in the king's house, who prefers Esther, gives her what she needs, and whose advice she follows: she "required nothing but what Hegai... appointed" (2.15). **Where it breaks:** Hegai's job ends at the king's door. Hannah's girls are hers to place, to lose, and to watch married down.
EBED-MELECH · JEREMIAH 38	**POSSIBLE** A palace servant who gets the king's permission and pulls a prophet out of a cistern with ropes and rags (Vol. I, 419). **Where it breaks:** Ebed-melech acts once, in the open. Hannah's whole method is the camera gaps.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
1 Samuel 1.15, "I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit," if she ever said it aloud	1 Samuel 2.4–8, the bows of the mighty broken and the poor raised from the dust
	Esther 2.15, where the girl wins by taking the keeper's advice

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Hannah, Abigail and Michal, 393. Echoes, labeled, 419. Esther, 399. The Temple and the Vowed, 501. The Trials' history and the 2085 cohort, 561.

TKC: TL · FR 23–25 · FR 29

Body and fear

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	**INFERENCE** A woman who never lets herself feel what she can't act on has a body that's learned to wait (**TL**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	Eden dies or is publicly rejected, and Naomi has to be taken out of reach of the Trials (**FR 29**). A candidate's death costs the Trial nothing, and her status simply goes back to her family (**FR 23–24**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE	–

WHAT HER BODY DOES WHEN THE EVENING RECKONING COMES UP AND EDEN'S NAME HAS MOVED

THE NIGHT SHE WAS MOST AFRAID IN SIX TRIALS, AND WHAT SHE DID WITH HER HANDS

Belief arc

TKC: FR 29–30 · FR 34

YOURS

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · 2085	INFERENCE The Trials are a ladder, and she's on it	The Trial is cancelled mid-cycle and the twelve go home with no placements (FR 34, FR 39)	
II · House Mother	Act on everything that matters (TL)		
III · Eden		Eden wins, or dies, or is rejected (FR 29)	
IV · Naomi			

WHO NOTICES SHE'S CHANGED, AND WHAT SHE DOES TO HIDE IT

TKC: TL · FR 27–34

Who she can move, and who can move her

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
NAOMI	Influence, not legal control, over whether she enters (**FR 27**)	
EDEN	The proof, either way, of whether the ladder can be climbed (**FR 29**)	
NAOMI'S FATHER	Elite ladder, below Crown level, living, gone from the household (**FR 31**)	
JUDAH	He knows about Hannah, and has always known (**TL**)	
THE 2085 COHORT	Eleven women who were measured against her, scattered through their Dominions. A network that doesn't wake before book two (**FR 34**).	
MIRIELLE · GAVIN · ABIGAIL	Her staff, or her colleagues. Decide which.	

POSSIBLE Four people know Azrael is alive, Judah, Lyris and two others (**TL**). Judah "has always known" about Hannah. One of the two others could be her.

WHAT JUDAH KNOWS ABOUT HER

Voice and contradiction

TKC: TL · FR 29

WRITING

THE CONTRADICTION	**INFERENCE** She delivers other women's daughters to the ladder every year and plans to keep her own off it unless the ladder proves it can be climbed (**FR 29**).
WHAT IT COSTS	—

LINES ONLY HANNAH WOULD SAY

HOW SHE SPEAKS TO THE CAMERAS, AND HOW SHE SPEAKS IN THE GAPS

TL | FR 27–34

THE EXIT

A designation lower than the Trials reach. It saves Naomi from the ladder by taking her off it.

MARGINALIA

The machinery around her

Hannah works inside the Trials as staff, which means the machinery runs through her hands every day. She knows where it's blind, the back staircases and the camera gaps (TL), and she's built her life on acting only where she can.

The rules around her daughter are fixed. Eligibility isn't entry, anyone can submit a name, and Naomi can submit her own (FR 27). A child's status comes through household registration, so Naomi is eligible through Hannah's household and standing, whatever her father's place (FR 31–32). The only door out of the Trials' reach is a lower designation (FR 29). Underneath all of it is 2085, the cohort that was assembled and measured and then sent home when Crest died and the Trial was cancelled (FR 34, FR 39). INFERENCE Hannah was one of the twelve. She's never said it out loud, and Naomi doesn't know (FR 30).

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the designations, 521.

The Trial that didn't happen

TKC: FR 34 · FR 39

INFERENCE

WRITING

INFERENCE In 2085 Hannah was one of twelve young women assembled, prepared and measured against each other, and then Crest died mid-cycle, Dorian's accession forced a transition, and the Trial was cancelled. The twelve went home with their designations intact and no placements (**FR 34**, **FR 39**).

1 · WHERE SHE WAS WHEN SHE HEARD, AND WHO TOLD HER

2 · WHAT SHE LEARNED ABOUT THE OTHER ELEVEN IN THOSE WEEKS

3 · WHAT SHE DECIDED ON THE WAY HOME, AND WHEN SHE FIRST ACTED ON IT

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Write her on the back stairs

Ten minutes of Hannah at two in the morning, walking House Aurem when no one's awake. No girl to manage, no camera on her.

If you stall: which stair creaks · what she checks first · what she carries · the room she doesn't go into · what she says to herself about Eden · what she'd write to Naomi if letters were safe.

WRITE

Hannah and Naomi

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–30

Naomi knows her mother was Vowed and is now House Mother. The cancelled cohort is what Hannah has never said out loud (**FR 30**).

WHAT HANNAH WANTS FOR NAOMI, AND WON'T SAY

WHAT NAOMI WANTS, AND HASN'T TOLD HER MOTHER

THE CONVERSATION AFTER THE DECLARATION, WHICHEVER WAY IT GOES

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING HANNAH'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–33

VOL. I · 391 · 501

PORTRAIT · NAOMI · HANNAH'S DAUGHTER · VOWED EDUCATION, FINAL YEAR

PART II · DOSSIER 9 · ✦

Naomi

*Her whole future turns on a girl she's never met. If Eden wins, her mother enters her in the Trials. If Eden dies or is publicly rejected, her mother gets her out (**FR 29**).*

ON THE RECORD

Hannah's daughter, one year from the end of the Vowed education program (**TL**). Eligible for the Trials through her mother's household and standing (**FR 31–32**). She keeps the name Naomi (**FR 33**).

STILL OPEN

Her age, where she studies, what she wants, and whether she'd enter if nobody asked her.

The Registry card

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 31–33

VOL. I · 501 · 529 · 563

Vowed Education Record

TEMPLE · _____

FINAL YEAR · ONE YEAR REMAINING (**TL**)

NAME OF RECORD	*NAOMI*_____
HOUSEHOLD	*Hannah's · eligibility through it (**FR 31–32**)*
FATHER	*elite ladder, below Crown level · living · not in the household (**FR 31**)*
COVENANT REGISTRY	*eligible once of age · not entered (**FR 27**)*
ENTRY	*by her mother's submission, or her own (**FR 27**)*

ELIGIBLE

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
NAOMI	Her mother	
	Her Vowed instructors	

The Prelate was renamed so Hannah's daughter could keep this name. "Nomi" was rejected as too close (**FR 33**).

HOW OLD SHE IS, AND HOW LONG UNTIL SHE'S ELIGIBLE

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–32

VOL. I · 501 · 523

The clerk's version and the true one

ON THE LEDGER	A Vowed education student in her final year, eligible through her mother's household (**TL, FR 31–32**).
WHAT SHE KNOWS	Her mother was Vowed and is now House Mother. She doesn't know about 2085 (**FR 30**).
WHAT'S BEING DECIDED FOR HER	Whether she enters. Hannah can submit her name and isn't the only one who can, and Naomi can self-nominate once she's eligible, the way Eden did (**FR 27**).
WHAT DECIDES IT	Eden. A win means Hannah enters her. A death or a public rejection means Hannah gets her out through a designation lower than the Trials reach (**FR 29**).
HER FATHER	Still living, on the elite ladder below Crown level, no longer in Hannah's household. Why he left stays open (**FR 31**).

WHAT A DAY IN VOWED EDUCATION LOOKS LIKE, HOUR BY HOUR

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TL · CR · FR 30

VOL. I · 501 · 509

WHO TEACHES HER	The Vowed education program (**TL**). The Crownward's Vowed are formed for intelligence, theological precision, and perfect devotion under close observation (**CR**).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** The files are silent. **INFERENCE** She's being taught the Temple's faith by the people who'll later assess girls like her.
WHAT SHE DOESN'T KNOW	The cohort her mother was part of (**FR 30**), so her picture of the Trials is the Broadcast's.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A GIRL LIKE HER

POSSIBLE A Vowed student is the Temple's own, formed to serve and to observe. If she enters the Trials, she enters as the daughter of a House Mother and a former Vowed woman, already fluent in what the Settling is watching for.

WHAT SHE BELIEVES ABOUT GOD THAT HER INSTRUCTORS WOULD MARK CORRECT, AND WHAT THEY WOULDN'T

RUTH 1.20–21

1 SAM 2.18–19

1 SAM 3

NUM 27.1–7

The Text

HER NAME	Naomi, Ruth's mother-in-law, whose name means "pleasant." Coming home widowed and childless she says, "Call me not Naomi, call me Mara," bitter (Ruth 1.20).
WHERE IT BREAKS	The biblical Naomi is old and plans a younger woman's future. This Naomi is young, and her future is being planned (Vol. I, 391).
SAMUEL · 1 SAMUEL 2–3	**POSSIBLE** The son of a woman named Hannah, raised in the sanctuary, ministering "before the LORD, being a child," with a little coat his mother brings every year (2.18–19). **Where it breaks:** Samuel is called by name at night, and the old priest teaches him to answer. Nobody's told Naomi there's anything to answer.
THE DAUGHTERS OF ZELOPHEHAD · NUMBERS 27	**POSSIBLE** Five sisters who bring their own petition and win it: "The daughters of Zelophehad speak right" (27.7). **Where it breaks:** Self-nomination is open to Naomi (**FR 27**). Whether she'd use it is the question.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
	Ruth 1.20, the bitterness inside her own name
	Numbers 27.7, a petition that wins

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ruth and Naomi, 391. Hannah, 393. Numbers, two petitions, 159. The Temple and the Vowed, 501. Eligibility and nomination, 563.

Body and fear

TKC: FR 29

WRITING

WHAT THE VOWED HAVE TRAINED HER BODY TO DO IN A WATCHED ROOM

WHAT SHE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN, AND WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE

TKC: FR 27 · FR 29–30

YOURS

Belief arc

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · Vowed education			
II · Watching Eden			
III · After the Declaration		Her mother's decision either way (**FR 29**)	
IV · Book two			

WHETHER SHE EVER FINDS OUT ABOUT 2085, AND FROM WHOM

Names, not roles

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–31

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
HANNAH		Influence, not legal control (**FR 27**)
HER FATHER		
EDEN	A stranger whose result decides her life (**FR 29**)	
HER INSTRUCTORS		

WHO SHE'D TELL FIRST IF SHE DECIDED TO ENTER HERSELF

WRITING

Voice and contradiction

LINES ONLY NAOMI WOULD SAY

THE THING SHE BELIEVES AND ALSO BREAKS

WHAT IT COSTS, AND THE SCENE WHERE IT LANDS

Write her watching the Broadcast

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Ten minutes of Naomi on an ordinary evening at seven, watching the Evening Reckoning wherever the Vowed students watch it. Eden's name is on the screen.

WRITE

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

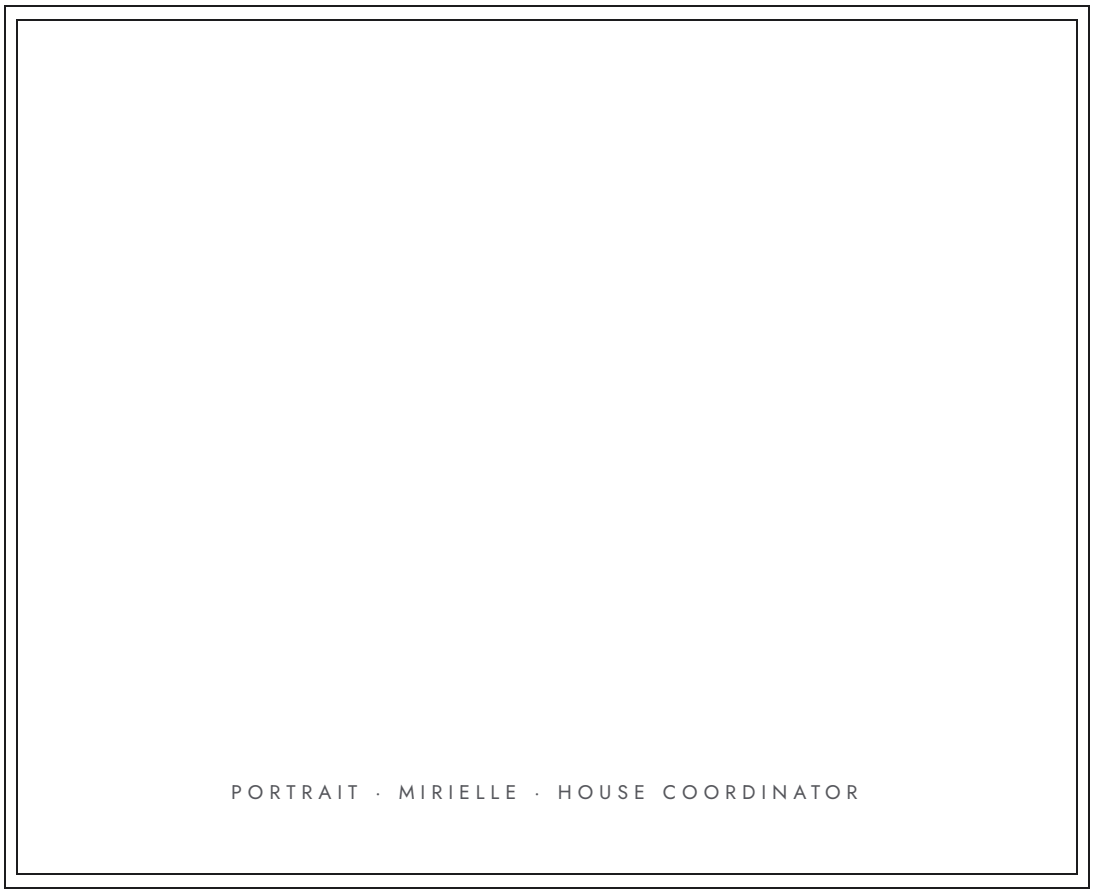
LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING NAOMI'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · CR · FR 26

VOL. I · 567



PART II · DOSSIER 10 · ✦ · SHORT

MIRIELLE

*She runs the House with the efficiency of someone who's decided not to waste time on things that won't help (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

House Coordinator of House Aurem. She hands Eden a shawl before Temple and says nothing else. She cries when Eden's name comes up first on the Sovereign Boulevard boards (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

How long she's served the House, where she's from, and who she cried for the last time a name came up first.

The record and the woman

TKC: TL · CR · FR 26

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

NAME	*MIRIELLE*_____
POST	*House Coordinator*
TRIALS SERVED	_____
DESIGNATION	_____

STAFF

WHAT SHE DOES	Runs the House (TL). INFERENCE Schedules, staff, the kitchen, the hours the cameras see and the ones they don't.
THE SHAWL	Before Temple she hands Eden a shawl and says nothing else (TL). INTERPRETATION The whole of her care is in the object.
THE BOARDS	When Eden's name comes up first, she cries (TL).

WHERE SHE'S FROM, AND HOW SHE CAME TO THE CROWNWARD

2 KGS 2.13–14

RUTH 3.9

EZEK 16.8

VOL. I · 391 · 413 · 513

Faith and scripture

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** The files give her efficiency and two gestures. **INFERENCE** A woman who cries at a girl's name on a board believes something about what the board means.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER	**POSSIBLE** Service without credit is the Crownward's highest female virtue, the Arrangement without the marriage (Vol. I, 527).
HER NAME	*Mirielle* has no biblical source. It's a French name, related to Provençal *Mireille*, usually taken from a word meaning "to admire." To an English ear it sits close to Miriam, Eden's mother's name. Whether Eden hears that is yours.
A GARMENT ECHO	**POSSIBLE** The mantle Elijah leaves for Elisha (2 Kgs 2.13–14), and Ruth asking Boaz to spread his cloak over her (Ruth 3.9). A cloth handed over in silence is old scripture's way of saying someone's taken responsibility for you. **Where it breaks:** Mirielle says nothing, and nobody's taking an oath.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER

Volume One: Ruth, 391. Kingmakers, prophets and priests, with Elijah, 413.

WHAT SHE SAYS TO GOD, OR TO NO ONE, THE NIGHT EDEN PLACES FIRST

Who she runs the House for

TKC: TL

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	A shawl, and tears at the boards (TL)
HANNAH	
GAVIN · ABIGAIL	
THE HOUSE STAFF BELOW HER	

LINES ONLY MIRIELLE WOULD SAY, AS FEW AS POSSIBLE

WRITING

Write the shawl

Ten minutes. The morning before Temple, the hallway, the shawl, and everything she doesn't say.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · GAVIN · STYLIST, HOUSE AUREM

PART II · DOSSIER 11 · ✦ · SHORT

Gavin

*He's never dressed anyone who understood that the dress isn't for her. He puts the bobby pin in every time. Every single time (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Stylist for House Aurem. Fourteen years, six Trials. He's dressed girls who were smarter, richer and better positioned than Eden (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

Who the dress is for, what the bobby pin holds, and which of his girls he still thinks about.

TKC: TL · MEN · FR 26

VOL. I · 507

The Record and the Man

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

NAME	*GAVIN*_____
POST	*Stylist · fourteen years · six Trials (**TL**)*
DESIGNATION	_____ *(MEN, by class)*
HOUSEHOLD	_____

STAFF

WHAT HE'S DONE	Fourteen years, six Trials, and girls smarter, richer and better placed than Eden (**TL**).
WHAT EDEN UNDERSTANDS	The dress isn't for her (**TL**). **INFERENCE** It's for the Broadcast, the Anointed Court and the screens, and she knows it.
THE BOBBY PIN	Every time (**TL**). **OPEN QUESTION** Where it goes, what it holds, and whether it's ever been more than a pin.
OPEN QUESTION	Which class of man is he, and whose approval did his marriage need, if he's married (Vol. I, 507)?

THE FIRST GIRL HE DRESSED FOR A TRIAL, AND WHAT HAPPENED TO HER

Faith and scripture

EXOD 28.2

EXOD 31.1–5

ESTH 2.12

MATT 6.28–29

VOL. I · 298 · 399

WHAT HE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** Nothing on file. **INFERENCE** Fourteen years of making girls look chosen has taught him something about what the Empire means by chosen.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM	**POSSIBLE** A craftsman serving the House is honored as a steward of beauty, and never asked what he's dressing girls for.
HIS NAME	*Gavin* has no biblical source. It's a Scottish and Welsh name, from the knight Gawain.
THE PRIEST'S GARMENTS · EXODUS 28	**POSSIBLE** Aaron's garments are made "for glory and for beauty" (28.2), and Bezalel is filled with the spirit of God "in wisdom... and in all manner of workmanship" (31.3). **Where it breaks:** Those clothes dress a priest for God. Gavin's dress a girl for a camera.
ESTHER'S YEAR · ESTHER 2.12	**POSSIBLE** Twelve months of preparation, six with oil of myrrh and six with sweet odours. **Where it breaks:** The king's women had no say in it. Eden knows exactly what the dress is for.

HE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HIM
	Matthew 6.28–29, the lilies of the field, "even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these"

Volume One: Esther, 399. The calf, the purge and the face, with the priest's garments, 298.

WHAT HE THINKS GOD MAKES OF HIS WORK

TKC: TL

Who he dresses

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	The dress, and the pin, every time (**TL**)
HANNAH · MIRIELLE · ABIGAIL	
THE OTHER HOUSES' STYLISTS	

LINES ONLY GAVIN WOULD SAY

Write the pin

WRITING

Ten minutes. Eden in the chair before the Anointed Evening, Gavin behind her, and the bobby pin.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: TL · WR 15 · WR 30

VOL. I · 393

PORTRAIT · ABIGAIL · DEBATE AND PROTOCOL ADVISOR · IN AMBER

PART II · DOSSIER 12 · ✦ · SHORT

ABIGAIL

*Pressure in a pretty dress. She doesn't need to threaten. A look, a small correction, a hand at the elbow or one soft line is enough (**WR 30**).*

ON THE RECORD

Debate and Protocol Advisor for House Aurem. She wears amber to the Theology debate, reads Eden the way professionals read what they've spent years learning, and called Serenity's question about Celeste almost to the word (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

Who Serenity is, what the question was, and why Abigail could see it coming.

The record and the woman

TKC: TL · TR · WR 30

VOL. I · 570

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

NAME	*ABIGAIL* _____
POST	*Debate and Protocol Advisor*
TRIALS SERVED	_____
DESIGNATION	_____

STAFF

WHAT SHE DOES	Prepares Eden for the Civic Debates, where the topic comes an hour before and the Broadcast edits the result (TR), and for the protocol of every watched room (TL).
HOW SHE READS	The way professionals read what they've spent years learning to read (TL).
THE AMBER	She wears it to the Theology debate (TL). OPEN QUESTION Is it a signal, and to whom?
SERENITY'S QUESTION	She called it, about Celeste, almost to the word (TL). OPEN QUESTION Who is Serenity? An interviewer, a Court wife, another candidate's advisor?

THE QUESTION SERENITY ASKED, AND THE ANSWER ABIGAIL DRILLED INTO EDEN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE QUESTION SERENITY ASKED, AND THE ANSWER ABIGAIL DRILLED INTO EDEN

Faith and scripture

1 SAM 25

1 SAM 25.24–31

VOL. I · 393 · 417

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** Nothing on file. **INFERENCE** A woman who reads people for a living believes in what works in a room.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER	**POSSIBLE** The Temple holds up the biblical Abigail as the model wife who calms an angry man with gifts and humility, and drops the part where she acts without telling her husband.
HER NAME	Abigail, Nabal's wife, who loads donkeys with food, rides out without telling her husband, kneels, takes the blame on herself, and talks an armed David out of a massacre he'd regret as king (1 Sam 25). The Talmud counts her among seven women prophets (Vol. I, 393).
WHERE IT BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** The biblical Abigail persuades a powerful man on her knees, once, on a road. This one teaches a girl how to do it on camera, every week, for a House.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
1 Samuel 25.24, "Upon me, my lord, upon me let this iniquity be"	1 Samuel 25.19, "But she told not her husband Nabal"

Volume One: Hannah, Abigail and Michal, 393. The names in the cast, 417.

WHAT ABIGAIL SAYS TO EDEN THAT THE BIBLICAL ABIGAIL SAID TO DAVID

TKC: TL · WR 15 · WR 30

Her voice

THE RULE	She needs her own rhythm, apart from the Empire's brochure voice (**WR 15**). She never over-threatens (**WR 30**).
ON THE PAGE	A look, a small correction, a hand at the elbow, one soft line (**WR 30**).

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	A professional read, and a prediction that came true (**TL**)
SERENITY	
HANNAH	

LINES ONLY ABIGAIL WOULD SAY, EACH UNDER TEN WORDS

Write the hour before the Theology debate

WRITING

Ten minutes. The topic's just come in, Abigail is in amber, and there's an hour.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: DR3

VOL. I · 501 · 509 · 565

PORTRAIT · SENIOR MINISTER BELL · THE AURELIA TEMPLE

PART II · DOSSIER 13 · ✦ · SHORT

BELL

*He prayed that God would close every door not intended for her (**DR3**).*

ON THE RECORD

Senior Minister of the Aurelia Temple. He signs Binding certificates, sponsors Assessment candidates, and has known Celeste thirty-four years. He wouldn't sponsor Eden (**DR3**).

STILL OPEN

His first name, his wife, his own children, and whether he ever regrets the prayer.

The record and the man

TKC: DR3 · TL

VOL. I · 501 · 523

Binding Certificate

TEMPLE OF AURELIA

SIGNED BENEATH EACH HUSBAND'S NAME

OFFICIATING	*Senior Minister Bell*
BRIDE	_____
HUSBAND	_____
WITNESS	*a Vowed officiant*

BOUND

HIS OFFICE	Signs Binding certificates beneath each husband's name and sponsors Assessment candidates (**DR3**).
CELESTE	Thirty-four years. Her sweet potato pie at harvest suppers, and a call every winter when the Temple needs coats repaired. He greets her with both hands and calls her Mother Parish. She answers "Morning" and he keeps smiling (**DR3**).
EDEN	He kept her waiting while he signed certificates. He asked whether her father was dead and whether her mother was properly Bound when she was born, not about her grades. He offered Leah Home Instruction and prayed every door shut that wasn't intended for her (**DR3**).
THE ASSESSMENT	He speaks before the scores about "divine order, talent as stewardship, and elevation as burden," reads Proverbs 31.29 from the Book of Covenant, and closes, "May every daughter receive with grace the portion appointed to her" (**DR3**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHY HE WOULDN'T SPONSOR HER, IN HIS OWN WORDS, TO HIS WIFE THAT NIGHT

Faith and scripture

WHAT HE BELIEVES	"The House always judges fairly" (DR3). INFERENCE He believes in the Temple's order sincerely, and it's never cost him anything.
WHAT HE PREACHES	Divine order, talent as stewardship, elevation as burden (DR3).
HIS NAME	*Bell* has no biblical source. INTERPRETATION A bell calls people in and tells them what time it is.
ELI · 1 SAMUEL 1–2	POSSIBLE The priest at Shiloh who watches a praying woman's lips move and decides she's drunk. His sons abuse the office, and he rebukes them and does nothing (1 Sam 2.12–17, 22–25). **Where it breaks:** Eli corrects himself when Hannah answers him. Bell never asked Eden a question he didn't already have an answer for.
AMAZIAH · AMOS 7	POSSIBLE The priest of Bethel who tells a prophet to go home, because "it is the king's chapel, and it is the king's court" (7.13). **Where it breaks:** Amos answers him to his face. Eden went home and found the clause.

HE QUOTES	NEVER PREACHED FROM HIS PULPIT
Proverbs 31.29, "Many daughters have done virtuously, but thou excellest them all" (DR3)	Revelation 3.8, "I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it"
	Amos 7.14–15, a herdsman God sent anyway

Volume One: Hannah and Eli's misreading, 393. The Twelve, with Amos, 138. What the Temple teaches, 509.

THE PRAYER, WORD FOR WORD, AS HE SAID IT OVER EDEN

1 SAM 1.12–16

1 SAM 2.12–17

AMOS 7.10–13

REV 3.7–8

PROV 31.29

VOL. I · 393 · 138 · 509

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE PRAYER, WORD FOR WORD, AS HE SAID IT OVER EDEN

His voice

TKC: DR3

ON THE PAGE	"What a joy to see you." "The House always judges fairly." "May every daughter receive with grace the portion appointed to her." (**DR3**)

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
CELESTE	Thirty-four years of pie and coats, both hands, "Mother Parish" (**DR3**)
EDEN	A sponsorship he wouldn't give (**DR3**)
LEAH	A consolation, Home Instruction the following year (**DR3**)
THE OFFICIALS	Where his attention goes during the Assessment, instead of to Eden (**DR3**)

WHAT HE SAYS ABOUT EDEN AT THE HARVEST SUPPER AFTER SHE PLACES FIRST

WRITING

Write the sponsorship, from his side

Ten minutes. Eden is in the chair by his desk. He has certificates to sign and he signs them first.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO.

DATE

The Aurem officials

TKC: TR · TL · DR3 · MEN · DOM

VOL. I · 565 · 503 · 523

People with an office and no dossier yet. Each one moves Eden's file, and most of them don't have names. Give one a page in the notes when they start to matter.

OFFICE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	NAME
THE GOVERNOR-PRELATE OF AUREM	Chose Eden second although she ranked first. In practice a Governor-Prelate takes whoever the Crown has quietly signaled it prefers (**TR**).	
HIS FIRST CHOICE	Withdrew the night before departure. Officially a family health emergency. It wasn't, and who arranged it is a question Eden will eventually answer (**TR**).	
THE DESIGNATION OFFICER	The Vowed officer who assessed Eden at eighteen and filed the flag that day, "Exceptional intellect. Monitor closely," later updated to "Selected for Trial" (**TL**).	
THE FEE CLERK	Counted Eden's ten dollars and inspected both sides of every bill (**DR3**)	
LEAH'S HOUSEHOLD OFFICER	Runs the quarterly Commonwife assessment. Has made an informal comment and filed nothing yet (**MEN**).	
THE CROWN EDUCATION OFFICER	Hasn't knocked yet. Will, within three months of Solomon's scores (**MEN**).	
MARIBEL VALE	A girl at Eden's Assessment, whose faith needed less maintenance than Eden's (**DR3**)	

OPEN QUESTION Corinne Vale of Meridian and Maribel Vale of Aurem share a surname (**TR, DR3**). Related, or a coincidence to fix?

TKC: TR · TL

VOL. I · 570 · 501

In the Crownward

OFFICE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	NAME
THE THEOLOGICAL INTERVIEW OFFICER	A senior Vowed officer with twenty years of the work. She pursues Eden for two hours and files a report three pages longer than any other, ending "I cannot determine which. I am not certain the distinction matters as much as it should" (**TR**).	
EDEN'S VOWED HANDLER	Assigned for the Testimony. Eden declines her in writing three days before (**TR**).	
THE TWO APPOINTED OFFICERS	Travel with Eden and Hannah from Aurelia (**TR**)	
THE CROWN ADVISOR AT THE PAIRING	Tries to resist when Judah sends the officials out (**TR**)	
SERENITY	Asked a question about Celeste that Abigail predicted almost word for word (**TL**)	

THE OFFICIAL WHO MATTERS MOST THAT I HAVEN'T NAMED YET

Working Questions for House Aurem

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

BACK MATTER LOG

1 · WHO ON THE HOUSE STAFF REPORTS TO WHOM OUTSIDE THE HOUSE? DOES ANYONE REPORT TO THE PRELATE, THE BROADCAST OR THE CROWN?

2 · WHAT DOES EACH OF THE FOUR WANT FOR EDEN, AND WHAT DO THEY WANT FOR THEMSELVES?

3 · WHAT HAPPENS TO HOUSE STAFF WHEN THEIR GIRL LOSES, OR DIES?

4 · HAS HANNAH EVER USED A CAMERA GAP FOR A GIRL BEFORE EDEN, AND WHAT DID IT COST?

5 · WHAT DOES THE HOUSE EAT, WHO COOKS IT, AND DOES ANY OF IT TASTE LIKE AURELIA?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

5 · WHAT DOES THE HOUSE EAT, WHO COOKS IT, AND DOES ANY OF IT TASTE LIKE AURELIA?